(3) Remove the supports and lower the vehicle.
(4) Tighten the lower suspension arm nuts to 203 N·m (150 ft. lbs.).

SHOCK

DESCRIPTION

The top of the shock absorbers are bolted to the frame. The bottom of the shocks are bolted to the axle brackets.

OPERATION

The shock absorbers dampen jounce and rebound motion of the vehicle over various road conditions and limit suspension rebound travel.

DIAGNOSIS AND TESTING - SHOCK ABSORBER

A knocking or rattling noise from a shock absorber may be caused by movement between mounting bushings and metal brackets or attaching components. These noises can usually be stopped by tightening the attaching nuts. If the noise persists, inspect for damaged and worn bushings, and attaching components. Repair as necessary if any of these conditions exist.

A squeaking noise from the shock absorber may be caused by the hydraulic valving and may be intermittent. This condition is not repairable and the shock absorber must be replaced.

The shock absorbers are not refillable or adjustable. If a malfunction occurs, the shock absorber must be replaced. To test a shock absorber, hold it in an upright position and force the piston in and out of the cylinder four or five times. The action throughout each stroke should be smooth and even.

The shock absorber bushings do not require any type of lubrication. Do not attempt to stop bushing noise by lubricating them. Grease and mineral oil-base lubricants will deteriorate the bushing.

REMOVAL

(1) Raise and support the vehicle and the axle.
(2) Remove the upper mounting bolts (Fig. 3).
(3) Remove the lower nut and bolt from the axle bracket. Remove the shock absorber.

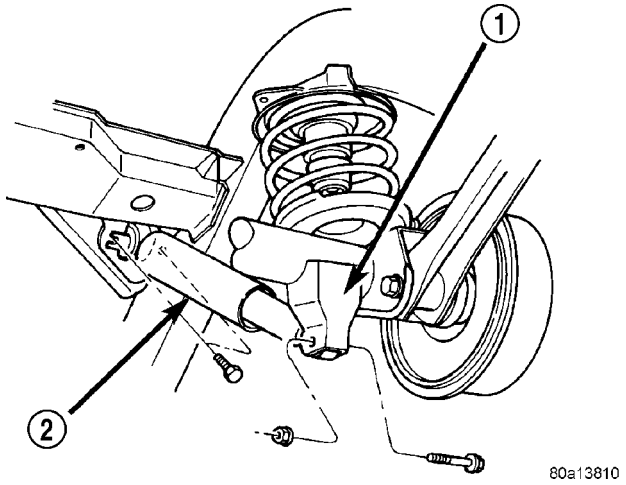

Fig. 3 Shock Absorber

1 - AXLE BRACKET
2 - SHOCK

INSTALLATION

(1) Install the shock absorber on the upper frame rail and install mounting bolts.
(2) Tighten the upper bolts to 31 N·m (23 ft. lbs.).
(3) Install lower bolt and nut finger tight.
(4) Remove the supports and lower the vehicle.
(5) Tighten the lower nut to 100 N·m (74 ft. lbs.).

SPRING

DESCRIPTION

The coil springs mount between the bottom of the frame rail and the top of the axle. A rubber doughnut isolator is located between the top of the spring and the frame rail. A plastic isolator is located between the bottom of the spring and the axle.

OPERATION

The coil springs control ride quality and maintain proper ride height. The isolators are used to isolate road noise.

REMOVAL

(1) Raise and support the vehicle. Position a hydraulic jack under the axle to support it.
(2) Disconnect the stabilizer bar links and shock absorbers from the axle brackets. (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/REAR/STABILIZER BAR - REMOVAL) (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/REAR/SHOCK - REMOVAL).
(3) Disconnect the track bar from the frame rail bracket. (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/REAR/TRACK BAR - REMOVAL).
(4) Lower the axle until the spring is free from the upper mount seat and remove the spring.